- Electro cardio gram (ECG)
- Cerebral angiography
- Carotid ultrasound
- Echocardiogram
- **Glasgow Coma Scale** (GCS)
- VSH/Doppler study of carotid arteries

Management

- **Anti-platelet drugs** Anti-platelet drugs make these cells less sticky and less likely to clot.
- **Anticoagulants** Reduce blood clotting
- **Physical therapy** such as walking, eating and dressing.
- **Speech Therapy**

Nursing Management

- Vital Signs
- Maintain neurologic flow sheet (Stroke scale)
- Assess for voluntary or involuntary movement.
- Monitor bowel and bladder function
- Assess the skin care
- Personal hygiene
- Support of vital function- Maintain air way. Breathing oxygenation circulation
- Assess the stroke scale
- Intra venous fluids at maintenance until able to tolerate oral diet
- Maintain Blood Pressure
- Acces the level of conciousness by usingn (GCS)
- Thrombolytic therapy - ischemic stroke
- Maintain normal body temperature
- Antispasmodic agents can be used for spastic paralysis

Surgical Treatment

- Carotid Endarterectomy to treat carotid artery disease
- Thrombectomy
- Hemycraniaetomy

Prevention

- Healthy diet
- Controlling high blood pressure (Hypertension)
- Quitting tobacco use
- Controlling diabetes
- Maintaining a healthy weight
- Exercising regularly
- Routine health assessment

Complications

- Aspiration pneumonia
- Dysphagia (Difficulty in swallowing)
- Spasticity, Contractness
- Brain stem herniation
- Deep vein thrombosis, pulmonary embolism
- Post stroke depression.

2.8 Head Injury

A head injury is any sort of injury to brain, skull, or scalp.

Common head injuries include concussions, skull fractures, and scalp wounds. The consequences and treatments vary greatly, depending on what caused your head injury and how severe it is.

Head Injury

Head injury can include fractures to the skull and face, direct injuries to the brain (as from a bullet) and indirect injuries to the brain (such as concussion, contusion or intracranial Haemorrhage).

Head injuries commonly occur from motor vehicle accidents, assaults or falls.

Key terms

Concussion: A temporary loss of consciousness

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